

How Could We Be So Wrong?

Heuristics : Mental shortcuts in forming and maintaining our beliefs

representativeness
availability
anchoring and adjustment

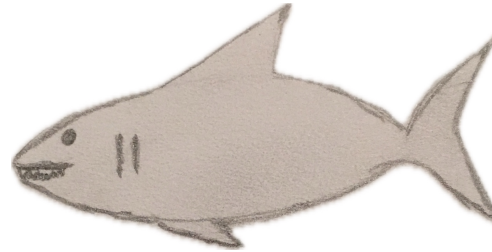
representativeness

Assuming rare cases occur more frequently or vice-versa



availability

More Known, available examples



anchoring and adjustment

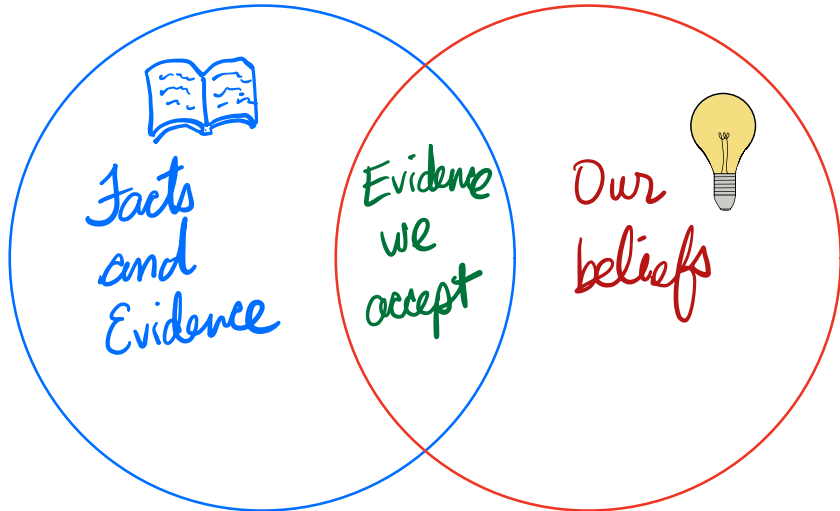
Tendency to use a given starting point (anchor), usually a starting number, as the basis for a subsequent judgement



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Confirmation Bias: Tendency to focus on cases that confirm our intuitive beliefs and to disregard cases that disconfirm our beliefs

- active process



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How to combat incorrect beliefs

Skepticism: pausing to consider alternatives and to search for evidence

Tolerance **of Uncertainty:** accepting that there are many things that we simply do not know